

BHARGAVI RAO BONDADA

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EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science (HCI focus), Boise State University, Boise, ID Expected Dec 2026
Thesis: Promoting Balanced Technology Use Through Collaborative Parent-Child Co-Regulation

B.Tech Computer Science, Vellore Institute of Technology, Chennai, India 2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher, Human-Computer Interaction, Boise State University 2025 to Present

- Led the user-centered design process for an IRB-approved thesis on family technology use: 2 participatory design sessions, 2 shipped apps, and two 7-day field studies with 16 families (32 parents and children) at 100% completion.
- Facilitated Kidsteam co-design, including a Layered Elaboration session where 4 child-adult groups iterated dashboard concepts over 3 critique rounds; distilled them into design principles (explain rules, involve children in decisions, make shared information understandable, let children control what is shared).
- Ran 42 pre- and post-study family interviews and synthesized them with the Parental Stress Scale, SUS, an adapted child usability survey, and in-app behavioral logs through qualitative coding in NVivo.

PROJECTS

KidsTechBalance 2.0 (KTB 2.0) | AI-enabled family co-regulation app | Flutter, Firebase, GPT-4o-mini, Swift, Kotlin

- Designed and built an intuitive cross-platform app (iOS, Android, Fire OS) that replaces one-way parental monitoring with shared decisions between two stakeholder groups, combining screen-time sessions, reflection nudges, shared tasks, moods, and a family dashboard.
- Integrated AI into the app: GPT-4o-mini in Cloud Functions generates daily reflection prompts for each family and screens children's written responses for signs of distress, sending the parent an automatic concern alert.
- Designed a two-role session flow: the parent sets duration and tasks, the child picks which apps stay available, and the child can request an early end that the parent approves or denies, giving children a voice instead of a workaround.
- Designed the shared dashboard from the Kidsteam paper prototype, pairing weekly device use and per-app daily usage with tasks, moods, and active sessions so screen-time data reads as family information, not a surveillance report.
- Achieved a mean parent System Usability Scale (SUS) score of 79.8, above the 68 industry average, with all 10 parents rating the app easy to use; nudges sparked a parent-child conversation in 6 of 10 families.
- Found children rated usability 8 points lower than parents (71.5 vs 79.8) and one could not read the usage graph, leading to display design recommendations for simpler child-facing data visualization.
- Built device-level app blocking in 1,600+ lines of native Swift and Kotlin (iOS Family Controls, Android UsageStats) within a 9,400+ line Dart app, giving me a developer's view of platform constraints.

NudgeLab | Reflection-based family nudge app | Flutter, Firebase

- Designed a lightweight digital alternative to detailed monitoring: parents and children each get 2 short reflection prompts a day at randomized times, inviting conversations about technology, feelings, and family expectations.
- Designed separate parent and child experiences with family code and PIN login, a nudge history with answered and unanswered filters, and child-controlled sharing so children's written reflections stay private unless they choose to share them.
- Deployed on iPhone, Android, and Amazon Fire tablets with 11 parent-child pairs (children aged 6 to 11) for 7 days with zero dropouts, logging when each prompt was delivered, opened, answered, or ignored.
- Found that nudges built awareness and that the conversation mattered more than the written answer, but reflection alone gave families too little structure; this finding drove the KTB 2.0 redesign with sessions and goals.

Lost and Found App | UX design project | Figma

- Designed the end-to-end user experience from user research and wireframes to a high-fidelity Figma prototype; a moderated usability test with 6 participants scored 4.83 out of 5 for ease of use.

SKILLS

UX Design: User experience design, user-centered design, interaction design, visual design, wireframing, user flows, prototyping (paper to high-fidelity), dashboard and data display design, design critique, design for children

UX Research: User experience research, participatory design (co-design), semi-structured interviews, usability testing and validation, SUS, surveys, field studies, behavioral analytics, qualitative coding and synthesis

Tools and AI: Figma, Framer, NVivo, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Flutter, Dart, Firebase, Git, OpenAI API (GPT-4o-mini)

Communication: Design documentation, technical writing, research presentations, cross-functional collaboration

PUBLICATIONS

- Bondada et al. Soul Support: Designing Hopeful Wearables for Children's Emotional Wellness. ACM IDC '25, 2025.
- Bondada. Survey Trends and Taxonomy Distribution in Large Language Models. EngrXiv preprint, 2024.